



MERGE 4 DESIGN LLC

ARCHITECTURE DEVELOPMENT CONSULTING

500 Delaware Ave., Suite 1 #1551,
Wilmington, DE 19899 · info@merge4design.com · 302 367 5726

PROFESSIONAL FEE PROPOSAL

1212 Lobdel Avenue — Multi-Unit Affordable Infill Housing

Wilmington, DE · Predevelopment & Architecture Services · April 2026

Submitted To	Wilmington Housing Authority (WHA) · Wilmington, DE
Submitted By	Merge 4 Design LLC (M4D) · 500 Delaware Ave., Suite 1 #1551, Wilmington, DE 19899 · 302 367 5726 · merge4design.com
Date Submitted	April 2026
Project Reference	M2_2026_012 · 1212 Lobdel Avenue
Proposal Valid	90 days from submission date



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01. Project Identification

Project Name	1212 Lobdel Avenue — Multi-Unit Affordable Infill Housing
Parcel ID	2605130241
Address	1212 Lobdel Avenue, Wilmington, DE (City of Wilmington limits)
Client / Owner	Wilmington Housing Authority (WHA)
Project Lead	Merge 4 Design LLC (M4D)
Zoning Jurisdiction	City of Wilmington Zoning Ordinance, Chapter 48 — R-3 District
M4D Project Number	M2_2026_005 · April 2026



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02. Project Context & Construction Scenario Overview

1212 Lobdel Avenue is a 1.39-acre cleared infill site within the City of Wilmington, owned by the Wilmington Housing Authority. The site is zoned R-3 (One-Family Row Houses, Chapter 48) and is targeted for 30+ units of affordable for-sale housing. M4D's predevelopment analysis evaluated four construction scenarios across the same Scenario I site layout — 36 units, 18 ft wide, 4-row configuration — to give WHA a full-spectrum cost and quality comparison.

2.1 Four-Scenario Summary

	Scn A CLT/SIP-Hybrid	Scn B Off-Site Modular	Scn C Stick-Build	Scn D Garage-Base / Garden Roof
Total Units	36	36	36	36
Unit Configuration	18 ft × 35 ft, 2-story	18 ft × 35 ft, 2-story	18 ft × 35 ft, 2-story	18 ft × 35 ft, 3-level Garage + L2 + L3 + Garden Roof
Unit Size	1,260 SF	1,260 SF	1,260 SF	1,890 SF (living)
Total ROM	\$14,875,352	\$9,200,026	\$14,731,123	\$11,123,852
Cost / Unit	\$413,204	\$255,556	\$409,198	\$308,995
Gap vs \$215K	~\$198K	~\$41K	~\$194K	~\$94K
Parking Strategy	Shared rear court	Shared rear court	Shared rear court	Private garage per unit
Amenity Zone	112.6 ft surplus	112.6 ft surplus	112.6 ft surplus	112.6 ft — full community green

CLT/SIP-Hybrid — Campus Scenario Context

The CLT/SIP-Hybrid scenario (Scenario A) reflects current Mid-Atlantic market conditions including a \$8–15/SF freight premium on CLT panels sourced from out-of-region suppliers and a Florida supply chain for AAC party wall panels. These premiums are the primary driver of the \$413K/unit cost in the current scenario. The Merge4Ward regional manufacturing campus — currently in early development with Wilmington-area project partners — is designed to eliminate both supply chain constraints by establishing Delaware's first regional CLT/SIP and AAC production facility on the I-95 corridor. When operational, the campus brings the CLT/SIP-Hybrid cost into near-parity with Scenario B (off-site modular), while delivering a noncombustible, energy-efficient, regionally manufactured building system that conventional framing and out-of-state modular cannot match. WHA's engagement on this project positions it as the anchor client for the campus's first production run.



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2.2 Recommended Program — Scenario I Site Layout (All 4 Scenarios)

Configuration	4 rows × 9 units per row · 18 ft wide × 35 ft deep per unit
Total Units	36 units — exceeds WHA 30-unit target by 20%
Site Area	1.39 acres / ±61,705 SF · 175 ft × 352.6 ft · Site fully cleared
Front Setback	20 ft (adopted) · Exceeds contextual average · Landscaped stoop zone
Rear Yard	20 ft required · 112.6 ft surplus amenity zone beyond Row 4
Max Height	35 ft / 3 stories · Scenario D height compliance to be confirmed at pre-application
Target Sale Price	\$200,000 – \$235,000 per home



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03. Rough Order of Magnitude Cost Analysis — All Four Scenarios

The following cost estimates are Rough Orders of Magnitude (ROM) based on available site information, current regional labor and material market conditions, and M4D's predevelopment cost analysis. These figures do not constitute a bid, guarantee, or warranty of construction cost. All values are subject to revision upon receipt of Phase I ESA, geotechnical data, confirmed zoning compliance, and construction type selection.

All four scenarios apply to the Scenario I site layout: 36 units, 4 rows of 9, 18 ft wide × 35 ft deep unit footprint. Scenario A uses Scenario I unit dimensions. Scenario D adds a garage level below the modular stack and a usable garden roof above, expanding the living program to 1,890 SF per unit.

3.1 Scenario A — CLT/SIP-Hybrid

**Cross-laminated timber structural panels + structurally insulated envelope panels. Off-site panel fabrication; on-site erection. Current Mid-Atlantic freight premium applies (\$8–15/SF). Cost position improves materially when regional manufacturing supply chain is established.*

Line Item	Scn I — 36 Units	Scn II — 40 Units	Scn III — 24 Units
Gross Floor Area (2-story)	45,360 SF	44,800 SF	36,480 SF
Sitework / Civil	\$432,000	\$480,000	\$288,000
Foundations (CLT-spec bearing, party wall footings)	\$1,179,360	\$1,164,800	\$948,480
CLT Structural Panels (supply + freight premium)	\$2,630,880	\$2,598,400	\$2,115,840
SIP Envelope Panels (ext walls + roof)	\$907,200	\$896,000	\$729,600
Erection Crew + Crane	\$360,000	\$400,000	\$240,000
Rough-in MEP	\$1,360,800	\$1,344,000	\$1,094,400
Interior Finishes	\$1,905,120	\$1,881,600	\$1,531,360
Doors, Windows, Hardware	\$270,000	\$300,000	\$180,000
Appliances Allowance	\$144,000	\$160,000	\$96,000
Site Utilities	\$306,000	\$340,000	\$204,000
Shared Open Space / Parking Court	\$200,000	\$200,000	\$175,000
Landscaping / Fencing / Unit Walks	\$162,000	\$180,000	\$108,000
SUBTOTAL — BASE CONSTRUCTION	\$9,857,360	\$9,944,800	\$7,710,680
General Conditions (10%)	\$985,736	\$994,480	\$771,068



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OH&P / GC Fee (8%)	\$868,648	\$875,942	\$679,341
Design Contingency (8%)	\$937,580	\$945,458	\$733,449
Soft Costs — Arch, Eng, Permits, Testing (12%)	\$1,517,678	\$1,530,742	\$1,187,447
Owner Contingency (5%)	\$708,350	\$714,571	\$554,099
SCENARIO A — TOTAL ROM	\$14,875,352	\$15,005,993	\$11,635,084
Cost Per Unit	\$413,204	\$375,150	\$484,795
Gap vs \$215K Target	~\$198K/unit	~\$160K/unit	~\$270K/unit



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3.2 Scenario B — Off-Site Modular

**Factory-built volumetric modules, crane-set on-site. Fastest schedule, highest quality control, lowest subsidy gap among the four scenarios in current market conditions.*

Line Item	Scn I — 36 Units	Scn II — 40 Units	Scn III — 24 Units
Gross Floor Area (2-story)	45,360 SF	44,800 SF	36,480 SF
Sitework / Civil	\$432,000	\$480,000	\$288,000
Foundations (modular-spec slab/piers)	\$816,480	\$806,400	\$656,640
Modular Factory Units (factory-complete, MEP rough-in incl.)	\$3,009,600	\$3,344,000	\$2,016,000
Freight + Set (crane, transport)	\$540,000	\$600,000	\$360,000
Site MEP Tie-Ins + Utility Connections	\$306,000	\$340,000	\$204,000
Exterior Finish Completion (siding, roofing, trim)	\$726,000	\$716,800	\$583,680
Interior Finish Completion (punch-out items)	\$234,000	\$260,000	\$156,000
Shared Open Space / Parking Court	\$200,000	\$200,000	\$175,000
Landscaping / Fencing / Unit Walks	\$162,000	\$180,000	\$108,000
SUBTOTAL — BASE CONSTRUCTION	\$6,426,080	\$6,927,200	\$4,547,320
General Conditions (8%)	\$514,086	\$554,176	\$363,786
OH&P / GC Fee (6%)	\$416,770	\$449,483	\$294,968
Design Contingency (6%)	\$441,776	\$476,452	\$312,606
Soft Costs — Arch, Eng, Permits (12%)	\$963,217	\$1,038,759	\$681,321
Owner Contingency (5%)	\$438,097	\$472,303	\$309,700
SCENARIO B — TOTAL ROM	\$9,200,026	\$9,918,373	\$6,509,701
Cost Per Unit	\$255,556	\$247,959	\$271,238
Gap vs \$215K Target	~\$41K/unit	~\$33K/unit	~\$56K/unit



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3.3 Scenario C — Conventional Stick-Build

**Traditional wood-frame construction. Highest local GC availability; longest schedule; highest labor content. Retained as baseline benchmark for grant applications requiring conventional cost comparison.*

Line Item	Scn I — 36 Units	Scn II — 40 Units	Scn III — 24 Units
Gross Floor Area (2-story)	45,360 SF	44,800 SF	36,480 SF
Sitework / Civil	\$432,000	\$480,000	\$288,000
Foundations (slab-on-grade, party wall footings)	\$816,480	\$806,400	\$656,640
Framing Lumber + Labor	\$1,587,600	\$1,568,000	\$1,276,800
Sheathing + Insulation + Weather Barrier	\$589,680	\$582,400	\$474,240
Roofing	\$363,480	\$358,400	\$291,840
Exterior Finish (fiber cement + brick base)	\$907,200	\$896,000	\$729,600
Rough MEP	\$1,587,600	\$1,568,000	\$1,276,800
Insulation + Drywall	\$635,040	\$627,200	\$510,720
Interior Finishes	\$1,724,688	\$1,702,880	\$1,386,240
Doors, Hardware, Appliances	\$414,000	\$460,000	\$252,000
Site Utilities + Connections	\$306,000	\$340,000	\$204,000
Shared Open Space / Parking Court	\$200,000	\$200,000	\$175,000
Landscaping / Fencing / Unit Walks	\$162,000	\$180,000	\$108,000
SUBTOTAL — BASE CONSTRUCTION	\$9,725,768	\$9,769,280	\$7,630,080
General Conditions (10%)	\$972,577	\$976,928	\$763,008
OH&P / GC Fee (8%)	\$855,868	\$859,697	\$671,847
Design Contingency (10%)	\$1,055,421	\$1,060,591	\$826,694
Soft Costs (12%)	\$1,448,578	\$1,455,011	\$1,134,194
Owner Contingency (5%)	\$672,911	\$676,076	\$527,292
SCENARIO C — TOTAL ROM	\$14,731,123	\$14,797,583	\$11,553,115
Cost Per Unit	\$409,198	\$369,939	\$481,380
Gap vs \$215K Target	~\$194K/unit	~\$155K/unit	~\$266K/unit



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3.4 Scenario D — Garage-Base / Garden Roof Townhouse (36 Units)

**Scenario D applies to Scenario I site layout (36 units, 18 ft × 35 ft footprint). Level 1: CMU/light steel garage on slab-on-grade. Levels 2–3: Off-site modular living stack (factory-complete). Roof: Usable garden/green roof deck. Living program expands to 1,890 SF per unit (3BR/2.5BA). Shared parking court eliminated — each unit has private garage. Amenity zone (112.6 ft) reprogrammed as full community green. Height compliance with Chapter 48 Sec. 48-151 (35 ft max) to be confirmed at City pre-application meeting.*

Line Item	Scenario I — 36 Units
Living GFA (L2 + L3, 2-story modular stack)	68,040 SF (36 × 1,890 SF)
Garage GFA (L1, CMU/steel slab-on-grade)	22,680 SF (36 × 630 SF)
Sitework / Civil	\$432,000
Foundations — Slab-on-Grade (simplified vs modular pier precision)	\$756,000
Garage Level Shell — CMU/light steel, 36 units @ \$22,000	\$792,000
Modular Factory Units — L2+L3 living stack, factory-complete, MEP rough-in incl.	\$3,009,600
Freight + Set — crane lift over garage podium	\$580,000
Site MEP Tie-Ins + Utility Connections	\$306,000
Exterior Finish Completion — 3-level facade	\$780,000
Interior Finish Completion + Module-to-Garage Interface	\$280,000
Garden Roof Deck — usable, structural, waterproofed, 36 units @ \$24,000	\$864,000
Amenity Zone / Community Green (visitor parking only, no shared lot)	\$120,000
Landscaping / Fencing / Unit Walks	\$200,000
SUBTOTAL — BASE CONSTRUCTION	\$8,119,600
General Conditions (8%)	\$649,568
OH&P / GC Fee (6%)	\$487,176
Design Contingency (6%)	\$487,176
Soft Costs — Arch, Eng, Permits (12%)	\$974,352
Owner Contingency (5%)	\$405,980
SCENARIO D — TOTAL ROM	\$11,123,852
Cost Per Unit	\$308,995
Gap vs \$215K Target	~\$94K/unit · ~\$3,383,820 total



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3.5 Master Comparison Matrix

Scenario	Units	Total ROM	\$/Unit	Gap/Unit	Rating
A — CLT/SIP-Hybrid (Scn I)	36	\$14,875,352	\$413,204	~\$198K	C
B — Off-Site Modular (Scn I)	36	\$9,200,026	\$255,556	~\$41K	A+
C — Stick-Build (Scn I)	36	\$14,731,123	\$409,198	~\$194K	C
D — Garage-Base / Garden Roof (Scn I)	36	\$11,123,852	\$308,995	~\$94K	B
A — CLT/SIP-Hybrid (Scn II, 40 units)	40	\$15,005,993	\$375,150	~\$160K	C
B — Off-Site Modular (Scn II, 40 units)	40	\$9,918,373	\$247,959	~\$33K	A++
C — Stick-Build (Scn II, 40 units)	40	\$14,797,583	\$369,939	~\$155K	C
A — CLT/SIP-Hybrid (Scn III, 24 units)	24	\$11,635,084	\$484,795	~\$270K	D
B — Off-Site Modular (Scn III, 24 units)	24	\$6,509,701	\$271,238	~\$56K	B
C — Stick-Build (Scn III, 24 units)	24	\$11,553,115	\$481,380	~\$266K	D

Rating methodology: A++ = best achievable gap with current financing programs; A+ = gap closeable with single-source subsidy (Delaware Catalyst Fund covers ~70%); B = gap requires layered subsidy (Catalyst Fund + HOME or LIHTC); C = gap requires extraordinary subsidy; D = not financially viable under current affordable housing financing structure without major program subsidy.



04. Scope of Services

M4D proposes services in two tracks. Track A — Predevelopment Intelligence — is authorized and delivered as a standalone fixed-fee engagement. Track B — Architecture & Engineering — is authorized separately upon WHA's selection of a construction type and yield scenario, and is structured as a lump-sum fee by phase.

4.1 Track A — Predevelopment Intelligence (Fixed Fee)

Item	Deliverable	Format	Schedule
A1	Site Assessment — parcel confirmation, governing zoning analysis, applicable code standards	Memo / Data Table	Week 1
A2	Three Yield Scenarios — unit count, site layout, regulatory envelope confirmation for Scenarios I, II, and III	Report + Site Diagrams	Week 1
A3	Construction Type Matrix — four systems (A through D) analyzed across all yield scenarios with cost ranges, per-unit cost, and gap analysis	Matrix Report	Week 1–2
A4	Sustainability Add-Alternate Analysis — geothermal HVAC (shared bore field), community solar PV, and rainwater harvesting; PACE financing applicability noted	Analysis Memo	Week 2
A5	3D Site Yield Study & Visualization — massing studies for all yield scenarios; solar access study; drive aisle and amenity zone layout; photorealistic perspectives	3D Visualizations + Site Plan	Week 2–3
A6	WHA Presentation Package — scenario comparison, cost matrix, sustainability options, and subsidy gap analysis compiled into a WHA-ready deck (PPTX + PDF)	Presentation Deck	Week 3–4
A7	Subsidy Gap & Grant Program Memo — Delaware Catalyst Fund, HOME, and DSHA program fit analysis	Memo	Week 3
A8	Gate 0 ROM Lock — cost estimates reconciled and locked; ALDDDB entry initiated	Internal / Summary	Week 4



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4.2 Track B — Architecture & Engineering Services (Lump Sum by Phase)

Track B is authorized separately following WHA's written selection of yield scenario and construction type. Each phase requires individual written authorization. Fees below are based on the Scenario I site layout (36 units); adjustments will be noted for Scenario D which carries additional design complexity.

Phase	Scope	Basis	Fee
B1	Schematic Design (SD) — all confirmed yield scenarios; unit plan types; 3D visualizations; site plan	Lump Sum	\$11,700
B2	Design Development (DD) — selected scenario; system coordination; structural and panel coordination	Lump Sum	\$17,550
B3	Construction Documents (CD) — permit-ready stamped set; all 36 units	Lump Sum	\$35,100
B4	Permitting & AHJ Coordination — City of Wilmington permit submission; plan review response	Hourly NTE	\$5,250
B5	Construction Administration (CA) — site observation; RFI/submittal review; punch list	Hourly NTE	\$9,450
B6	Reimbursable Expenses — printing, travel, plots (billed at cost)	Actual	~\$4,000

Subconsultants (Civil Engineer, Structural Engineer, MEP Engineer) are not included in the M4D fee. Budget approximately 12% of construction cost. Subconsultants will be engaged per written authorization from WHA and M4D.

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Item	Service	Hrs (Est.)	Rate	Fee
A1	Site Assessment & Zoning Analysis	18	\$185/hr	\$3,330
A2	Three Yield Scenarios + Site Layout	24	\$185/hr	\$4,440
A3	Construction Type Matrix (4 systems × 3 scenarios)	8	\$185/hr	\$1,480
A4	Sustainability Add-Alternate Analysis	6	\$185/hr	\$1,110
A5	3D Site Yield Study & Visualization	12	\$165/hr	\$1,980
A6	WHA Presentation Package	10	\$165/hr	\$1,650
A7	Subsidy Gap & Grant Program Memo	8	\$165/hr	\$1,320
A8	Gate 0 ROM Lock	5	\$185/hr	\$925
TRACK A TOTAL — FIXED FEE		91 hrs	—	\$16,235

5.2 Track B — Architecture & Engineering (Lump Sum by Phase)

Phase	Scope	Basis	Fee
B1	Schematic Design	Lump Sum	\$11,700
B2	Design Development	Lump Sum	\$17,550
B3	Construction Documents	Lump Sum	\$35,100
B4	Permitting & AHJ Coordination	Hourly NTE	\$5,250
B5	Construction Administration	Hourly NTE	\$9,450
B6	Reimbursable Expenses	Actual	~\$4,000
TRACK B SUBTOTAL		—	\$83,050

5.3 Combined Fee & Track A Credit

	Amount
Track A — Predevelopment Intelligence (Fixed Fee)	\$16,235
Track B — Architecture & Engineering (Lump Sum by Phase)	\$83,050
Track B — Reimbursable Expenses (estimated)	~\$4,000



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COMBINED TOTAL — TRACKS A + B

~\$103,285

★ **TRACK A FEE CREDIT** — Upon WHA's written authorization of Track B (full design services through Construction Documents), M4D will credit the full Track A fee of \$16,235 against the Track B Phase B1 invoice. This credit reflects M4D's commitment to a long-term WHA relationship and its confidence in this project proceeding to full design authorization.

(\$16,235)

NET TOTAL AFTER TRACK A CREDIT (upon Track B authorization)

~\$87,050

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#	Action	Lead	Timeline
1	Authorize Track A — Predevelopment Intelligence (\$16,235 fixed). Execute M4D PSA M2_2026_005.	WHA + M4D	Immediate
2	Request City of Wilmington Land Use pre-application meeting — confirm R-3 use, block face setback, 10-unit row cap, overlays, and Scenario D height compliance.	M4D	Week 1
3	Order Phase I Environmental Site Assessment — prior school facility history; possible asbestos, underground tanks, contaminated soil.	WHA	Week 1
4	Authorize geotechnical investigation (minimum 4 test borings). Critical for foundation design across all four construction types.	WHA	Week 1–2
5	Confirm WHA homebuyer income targeting (% AMI) and subordinate financing capacity — determines subsidy stack and Catalyst Fund eligibility.	WHA Finance	Week 2
6	RFI to modular manufacturers: 18 ft wide × 35 ft deep × 2-story, 36 units, Mid-Atlantic delivery. Also confirm Scenario D podium-set capability.	M4D	Week 2
7	Confirm Delaware Catalyst Fund eligibility for Lobdel at \$35K/unit × 36 units = \$1.26M. Coordinate with DSHA.	M4D + WHA	Week 2–3
8	WHA presentation — all 4 construction types, 3 yield scenarios, ROM comparison, sustainability options.	M4D + WHA	Week 4–5
9	WHA construction type selection and written authorization of Track B. Track A credit applied at Phase B1 invoice.	WHA	Post-presentation



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07. Authorization — Track A

To authorize Track A services, please execute this proposal and return a signed copy to M4D. A Professional Services Agreement will be issued upon receipt. Services commence within three (3) business days of executed PSA and receipt of retainer.

Track A Fixed Fee

\$16,235.00

Retainer (50% due upon authorization): \$8,117.50

Delivery: 4 weeks from written authorization

Governing agreement: M4D PSA
M2_2026_012-PSA (to be issued)

Invoice: Net 15 days

AUTHORIZED BY — MERGE 4 DESIGN LLC

Trevor Knight, Dir.of Business Development
Merge 4 Design LLC

Date: _____

David Ainsworth AIA, Principal-in-Charge
Date: _____

AUTHORIZED BY — WILMINGTON HOUSING AUTHORITY

Name: _____

Title: _____

Date: _____

FLAG FOR LEGAL/FINANCIAL REVIEW: Confirm WHA procurement requirements (DBE/MBE thresholds, HUD Section 3, City of Wilmington local hiring provisions) before contract execution. This proposal does not constitute a contract. ROM figures do not constitute a bid, guarantee, or warranty of construction cost. Professional legal review is recommended prior to execution.